# CHRISTMAS BUDGET KIT

Decide the total first. Then spend the season calmly - every gift, party and trip inside one number you chose on purpose.

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## START HERE - HOW THIS KIT WORKS

1. Set your total first (p.2). One number for the whole season, chosen before you spend anything.
2. Split the total into seven caps: gifts, party & food, travel, decorations, cards & postage, giving, and everything else.
3. List the gifts before you shop (p.3-4) - one cap per person, so nobody gets forgotten or overspent on.
4. Write spending down as you go (p.5). Two honest minutes after each shop, not a January surprise.
5. At the sales, use the 24-hour rule (p.7). If it was not on your list, it waits a day.
6. In January, look back once (p.9) - the real numbers, and three things to carry into the new year.

**THE ONE RULE**

The total comes first. Caps can move between categories - the total doesn't. If a page in this kit doesn't help you keep the total, skip the page.

## WHAT'S INSIDE


**p.2** Holiday Budget at a Glance - the total and the seven caps
**p.3-4** Gift List Planner - 40 people, a cap for each
**p.5** Holiday Spending Tracker - every purchase, as it happens
**p.6** Party & Food Budget - menu, shopping, hosting extras
**p.7** Black Friday & Sales List - planned buys only, with the 24-hour rule
**p.8** Everything Else Budget - travel, cards, decorations, giving
**p.9** January Look-Back - the season in numbers, and a clean start


Print at 100% (actual size). Print just the pages you need - the gift list and the tracker are made to be reprinted. Black & white throughout, easy on home ink.

# Holiday Budget at a Glance

One page holds the whole season: your total, the cap for each part of it, and how much of each cap is already spent.

## MY TOTAL HOLIDAY BUDGET

**$** _____

Decide this number first - before the first purchase.

| Category | Cap $ | Spent so far $ | Still left $ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Gifts | | | |
| Party & food | | | |
| Travel | | | |
| Decorations | | | |
| Cards & postage | | | |
| Giving | | | |
| Everything else | | | |
| **TOTAL** | | | |

### HOW TO KEEP THIS PAGE TRUE

Once a week, add up the tracker (p.5) and update the "Spent so far" column. Two minutes, once a week - that is the whole system.
Caps can move between categories. The total doesn't.

# Gift List Planner

Everyone you are buying for, one line each - with a cap per person, set before you shop.

| Person | Gift idea | Cap $ | Actual $ | Bought | Wrapped |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
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| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |

**PAGE TOTALS** caps $ _____ actual $ _____

# Gift List Planner (continued)

More people, same rule: a name, an idea, and a cap for each.

| Person | Gift idea | Cap $ | Actual $ | Bought | Wrapped |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
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**PAGE TOTALS** caps $ _____ actual $ _____

# Holiday Spending Tracker

Every purchase, written down the day it happens - gifts, food, travel, all of it. This page feeds the totals on p.2.

| Date | What I bought | Category | Planned $ | Actual $ |
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Running low in one category? Move a cap on p.2 - don't borrow from the total.

# Party & Food Budget

For the meal (or meals) you are hosting: the menu, the shopping, and the little extras that quietly add up.

**PARTY & FOOD CAP (from p.2)** **$** _____ Guests coming: _____

## THE MENU

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

## SHOPPING LIST

| Item | Budget $ | Actual $ |
|---|---|---|
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## HOSTING EXTRAS - the quiet add-ons

- ☐ Drinks $ _____
- ☐ Ice & paper goods $ _____
- ☐ Extra seating & tableware $ _____
- ☐ Music, games & candles $ _____

# Black Friday & Sales List

Sales are where good budgets go quiet. List what you planned to buy at a discount - before the sale starts.

**THE 24-HOUR RULE**

If it wasn't on this list before the sale, it waits 24 hours. Still want it tomorrow - and it still fits the cap? Then it's a plan, not an impulse.

| Store | Item | Was $ | Sale $ | Planned | Impulse |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ | ☐ |
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**Before you check out: total this page, then check it against your caps on p.2.**

# Everything Else Budget

The spending that isn't gifts or the party: travel, cards, decorations, giving. It all comes out of the same total.

## TRAVEL

| | Budget $ | Actual $ |
|---|---|---|
| Fuel & tolls | | |
| Flights, trains & stays | | |
| Food on the road | | |
| | | |

## CARDS & POSTAGE

| | Budget $ | Actual $ |
|---|---|---|
| Cards | | |
| Stamps & postage | | |
| Wrap, ribbon & tags | | |
| | | |

## DECORATIONS

| | Budget $ | Actual $ |
|---|---|---|
| Tree | | |
| Lights & candles | | |
| Table & home | | |
| | | |

## GIVING

| | Budget $ | Actual $ |
|---|---|---|
| Charity donations | | |
| Teacher & service gifts | | |
| School & community | | |
| | | |

# January Look-Back

Once, in January, with a cup of something warm. Ten minutes - then this page becomes next year's head start.

## THE SEASON, IN NUMBERS

My total cap was **$** _____

I actually spent **$** _____

The difference **$** _____ (under is a win. Over is information.)

## WHAT SURPRISED ME - the spending I didn't see coming

## WHAT WORKED - worth doing again

## THREE THINGS TO CARRY INTO JANUARY

**1.** _____

**2.** _____

**3.** _____

**A NEW YEAR STARTS ON THIS PAGE**

With the real numbers, not a guess. Keep this page with the kit - it is the first page of next year's calmer season.